Module 15 - chapter 23
Project: Run Ansible from Jenkins Pipeline - Part 3

Optimizations

The remote IP address of ansible server is repeated several times, so we can improve that for maintainability.

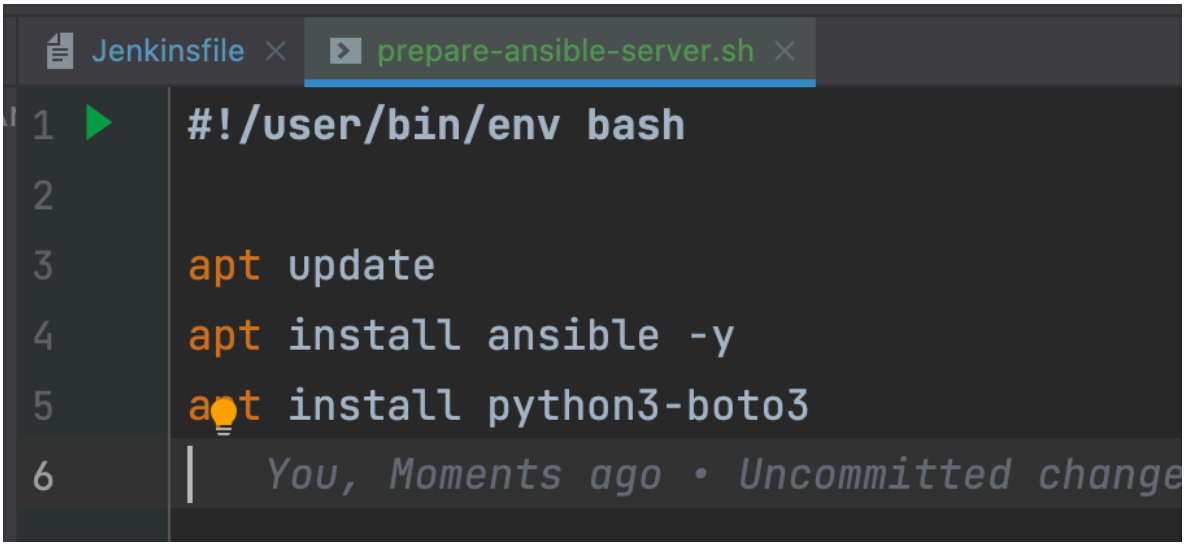
So I create an environment var

And use it where need it

Another thing that we can improve is to automate the manual process of configuring the ansible server using a script
-> sshScript

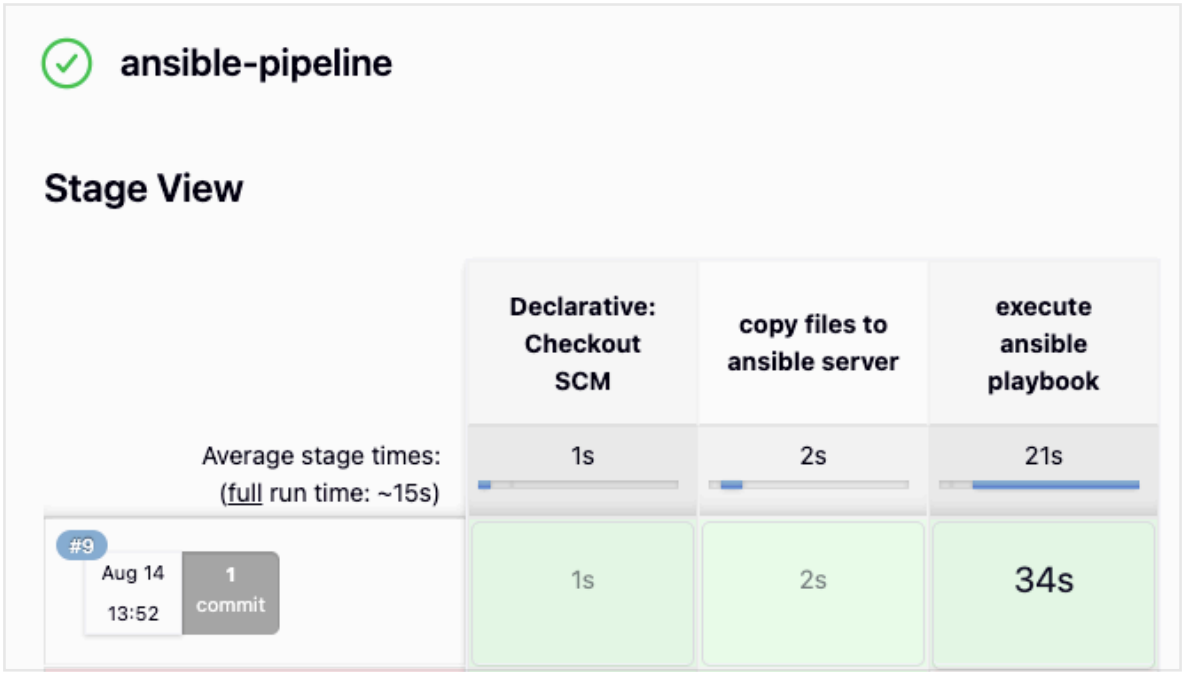
When we created the ansible droplet we manually sssh into it and installed ansible and install python3-boto3 (see Module 15 - chapter 21)

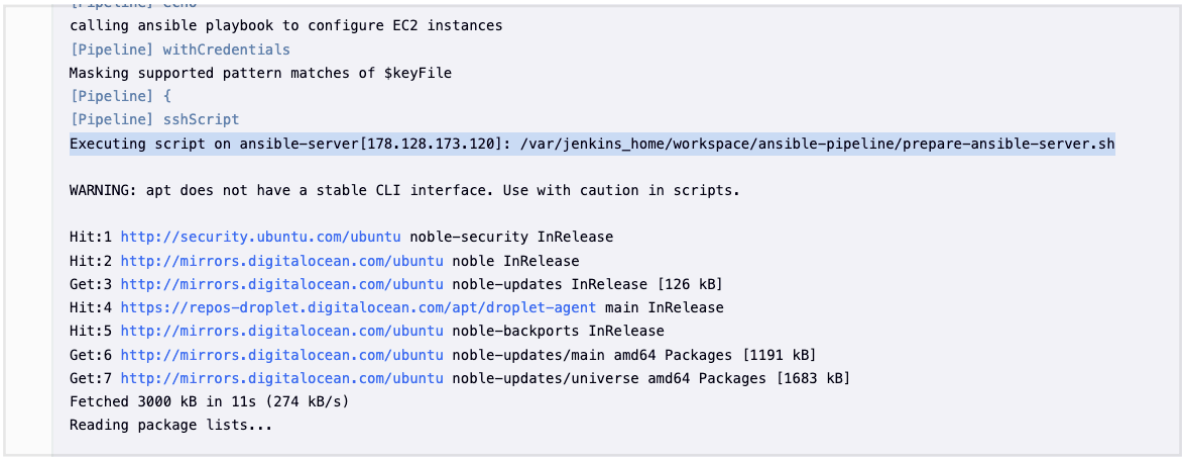
So now we can create a shell file with that configuration



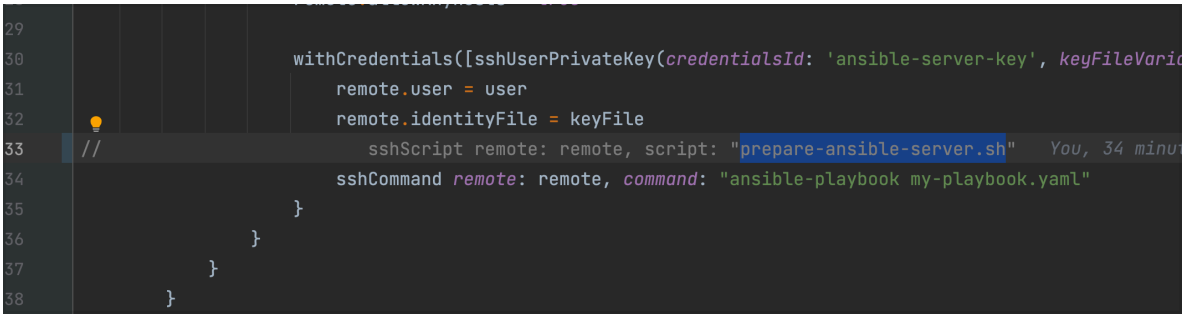
And then we can use that in jenkinsfile 💡 this way if we have ansible servers that get destroyed or created dynamically we can configure them efficiently.

The script will executed in the pipeline every time the build runs.





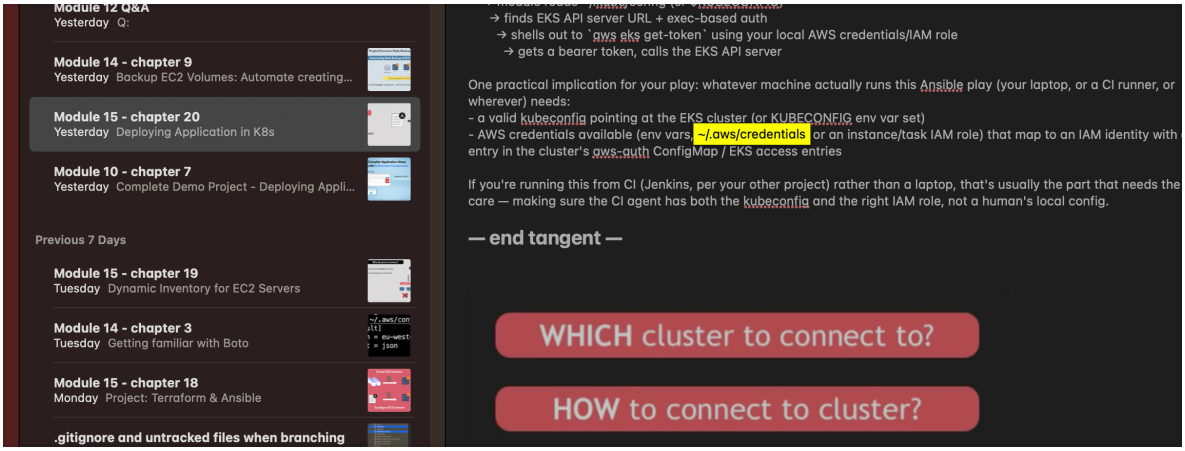
This step is **optional**, it depends on how we handle our servers



Another optimisation but we won't implement in this chapter:
We could also automate creating the AWS credentials (~/.aws/credentials) on the remote ansible server by creating the credential in jenkins

- AWS access key
- AWS secret access key

If we need to access AWS API we need AWS credentials like we did in Module 15 - chapter 20. Locally the credentials get stored in -> ~/.aws/credentials



call the AWS API — e.g. to create/modify EC2 instances, security groups, S3 buckets, etc. via Ansible's amazon.aws collection modules. Those modules need AWS_ACCESS_KEY_ID / AWS_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY available on the machine running them.

instead of manually SSH-ing into the ansible-server yourself and hand-typing your AWS access key/secret into a ~/.aws/credentials file (or exporting them as env vars) so Ansible can talk to AWS — automate that the same way you automated the pem file: store the two values as Jenkins credentials (which you've already done — good), then have the Jenkinsfile pull them via withCredentials and push them onto the ansible-server itself (e.g. write ~/.aws/credentials, or export them before running ansible-playbook).